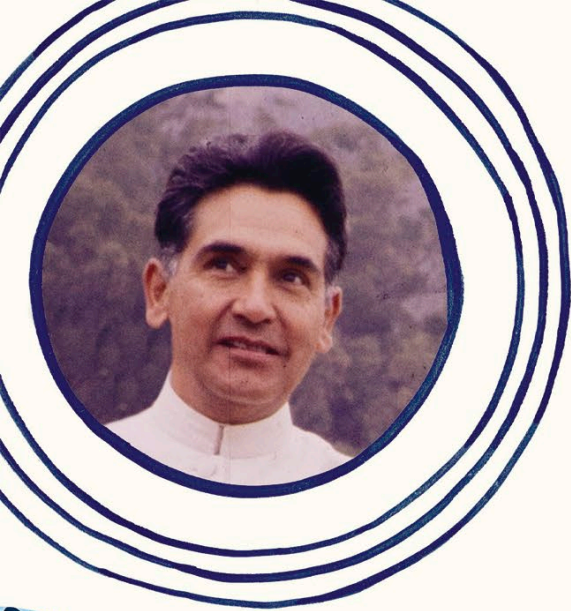




ALBERT BAEZ

Mexican physicist and educator
1912–2007

Albert was born in Mexico, but grew up in New York City. After studying math and physics, he began research into the uses of X-rays. He was interested in using these invisible rays to make more powerful microscopes.

Normal microscopes collect the light bouncing off an object and pass it through glass lenses. As light passes from air to glass, it slows down and changes direction. This bending—known as refraction—causes the object to appear bigger through the glass. Albert wanted to use X-rays instead of light, but X-rays are not refracted by glass.

Unusual talent in science must be sought out and nurtured because it is more precious than gold or uranium.

Albert worked with a scientist named Paul Kirkpatrick on a design for an X-ray microscope. A strong-enough source of X-rays was found 20 years later, which allowed Albert and Paul's system finally to be used.

